

Cambridge Road Safety Methodology

PS01 | Observation window 2023–2025 | Source downloads September 17, 2026

Purpose: help senior city leaders prioritize pedestrian and cyclist safety audits. The analysis screens reported crash concentrations; it does not estimate risk per traveler or determine which intervention will work.

Sources and collection

Two CSVs were manually downloaded from Cambridge’s public data portal. The CPD Crash Log contains 15,485 records (2016–September 2026); the detailed Police Department Crash Data contains 17,084 (2015–August 2026). The files overlap and were not appended. CPD is the counting source; the detailed file provides a cross-check. Neither has exact duplicate rows after whitespace trimming. Timestamps are not unique identifiers.

Study population and units

Retain January 1, 2023–December 31, 2025, the latest three complete years in the downloads, with records in all 36 months. Of 4,924 CPD crashes, retain 696 with at least one cyclist or pedestrian: 438 cyclist-involved and 260 pedestrian-involved, including two involving both. Each row counts once in combined totals. Annual totals are 231, 238 and 227. Units are crashes, not people. The detailed file has 4,926 records in this window; the two-record difference remains unresolved.

Cleaning and prioritization

Trim and uppercase street labels, remove punctuation, standardize common suffixes, and normalize MASS AVE and MT AUBURN. Alphabetize two distinct, nonempty street names to match reversed pairs. Do not guess ambiguous names. This identifies 430 crashes across 290 street-pair labels; 266 (38.2%) lack an explicit pair. Rank by crash count, retain ties, and use any-injury counts then alphabetical order only for display. Six locations have at least six crashes and together account for 42. Injury means any injured person in a crash, regardless of travel mode; it does not measure severity.

Website mapping and privacy

The September 19 local preview reports 322 crashes mapped to 200 unique Cambridge GIS intersection matches (46.3% of 696). Of 108 unmatched intersection crashes, six have address-like or non-public labels withheld, giving 272 public unresolved records and 102 other unmatched crashes. Map coverage differs from intersection-label coverage. Public displays use aggregates; downloads omit individual incident timestamps, medical details and address-level records. GIS matching follows the site’s documented method; coordinates were not independently audited for this note.

Limitations and interpretation

Reporting can omit crashes and near misses. Missing locations and unresolved spelling variants can alter priorities. No pedestrian, cyclist or vehicle exposure counts are available. Small annual counts cannot establish causal effects or reliable trends. Complete calendar coverage does not prove complete reporting. Field audits, location reconciliation, exposure counts and review of current street changes are needed before investment decisions.

Sources and definitions

[CPD Crash Log](#)

[Detailed crash data](#)

[GIS intersection definitions](#)